

- ☉ Poor: Not the brightest crayon in the box, riddles soar over your head.
- ☉☉ Average: You're smart enough to know when to seek help.
- ☉☉☉ Good: Given enough time, you can work through most problems that stump others.
- ☉☉☉☉ Exceptional: You can easily synthesize disparate information to draw new conclusions.
- ☉☉☉☉☉ Outstanding: You have the wisdom of Solomon; no subject is beyond your ken.

Specialties: Scholarly, Creative, Subject Expertise, Trivia, Logical

Wits

Wits governs a character's ability to think on his feet in stressful and quickly-shifting situations. It reflects his cleverness and adaptability. A character with low Wits is gullible and perpetually caught off guard. A character with high Wits always has a plan and can easily roll with whatever life throws his way. In court or on the battlefield, he is sharp and not to be trifled with.

- ☉ Poor: Go see what the redcap wants for dinner.
- ☉☉ Average: You can handle polite conversation, but don't go into politics.
- ☉☉☉ Good: You can hold your own in a debate and are rarely left dumbfounded.
- ☉☉☉☉ Exceptional: You're known for your sharp tongue; no one can get the drop on you.
- ☉☉☉☉☉ Outstanding: Like Sinbad or Odysseus, you can overcome any obstacle.

Specialties: Instinctive, Clever Retorts, Pre-Emptive, Change of Plans, Cool Headed

Abilities

Abilities are Traits that represent what a character knows and what she has learned to do. If Attributes are raw potential, Abilities are how a character harnesses it. A character only needs Dexterity to flail to the beat of the music. She needs Performance to dance the waltz. Most actions that require a dice roll will use an Attribute paired with an Ability to create the total dice pool.

There are 30 Abilities separated into 10 Talents, 10 Skills, and 10 Knowledges. Each Ability normally represents a broad range of subjects. Certain Abilities, such as Crafts and Performance, have a Specialty even if a character's rating is not 4 or higher. For example, she might be versed in all forms of Performance, but be especially practiced in dance.

Talents

Talents represent innate Abilities every character possesses without instruction. The only way to improve Talents is through practice. If a character attempts an action using a Talent she does not possess, she uses her full Attribute rating. Talents are so intuitive almost anyone can try them.

Alertness

Alertness indicates a character's attention to the world around him, even when he's not actively looking or otherwise distracted. It measures how connected he is to the tangible surroundings — anything he can see, touch, taste, or smell. Alertness allows the character to notice the subtle details and changes in his environment.

- ☉ Novice: You are alert and pay attention more than most.
- ☉☉ Practiced: You are attentive and keep an eye out.
- ☉☉☉ Competent: You keep a sharp eye on your environment.
- ☉☉☉☉ Expert: You rarely let your guard down.
- ☉☉☉☉☉ Master: Nothing escapes your eagle eyes.

Possessed by: Detectives, Journalists, Security Guards, Hunters, Thieves

Specialties: Eavesdropping, Danger Sense, Fine Details, Wilderness, Streets

Athletics

Athletics represents a character's basic physical prowess, as well as any experience she has with sports or exercise. Climbing, running, leaping, swimming, and throwing, as well as the rules and play of sports, are all encompassed by Athletics. This Ability does not include activities covered by other Abilities, such as Brawl or Melee.

- ☉ Novice: You were always picked first for teams in primary school.
- ☉☉ Practiced: You were on your high school football team.
- ☉☉☉ Competent: You probably had a college sports scholarship.
- ☉☉☉☉ Expert: You could be a professional trainer or athlete.
- ☉☉☉☉☉ Master: You compete at the Olympic level.

Possessed by: Athletes, Gymnasts, Jocks, Kids, Dancers

Specialties: Acrobatics, Parkour, Mountain Climbing, Track & Field, Swimming

Brawl

Brawl is any kind of fighting without a weapon. From street fighting relying on punching and kicking to formal martial arts training, a character uses this Trait when he finds himself in a tooth-and-nail situation. Brawling is up close, personal, and messy. To be the last one standing, anyone in a fight must be able to take as much punishment as he gives.

- ☉ Novice: You've been in a fight or two.
- ☉☉ Practiced: You could hurt someone in a bar room brawl.
- ☉☉☉ Competent: You know how to take down an opponent quickly.
- ☉☉☉☉ Expert: The MMA is trying to recruit you.
- ☉☉☉☉☉ Master: Your hands are considered deadly weapons.

Possessed by: Bouncers, Cops, Thugs, Martial Artists, Soldiers

Specialties: Any Martial Arts Style, Dirty Fighting, Wrestling, Boxing, Warrior's Halo